

The mess cooks for 340. About 252 come to eat.

● Subscribed

● Kitchen cooks for

● Actually came

398

340

252

Average per meal over 5 meals we counted. "Cooks for" = diners x cooked / served.

The user

The Dihing Hostel mess manager, deciding cook quantities before anyone walks in.

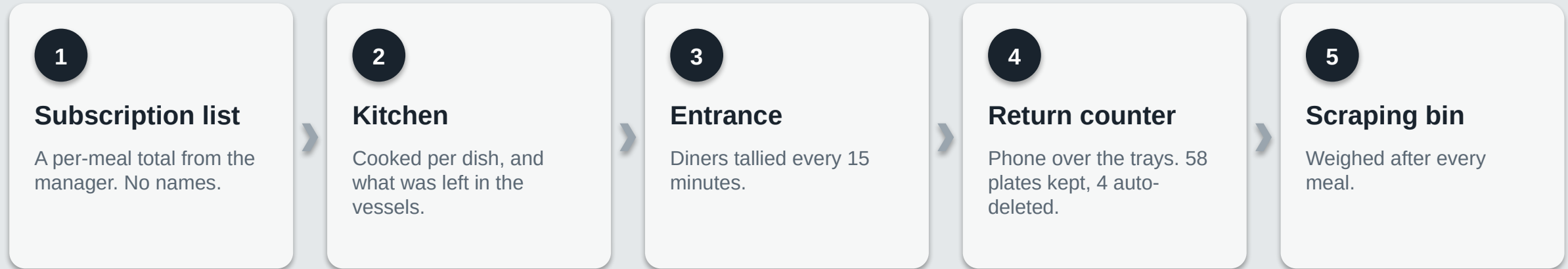
The question

How much of the waste is cooking for people who never come?

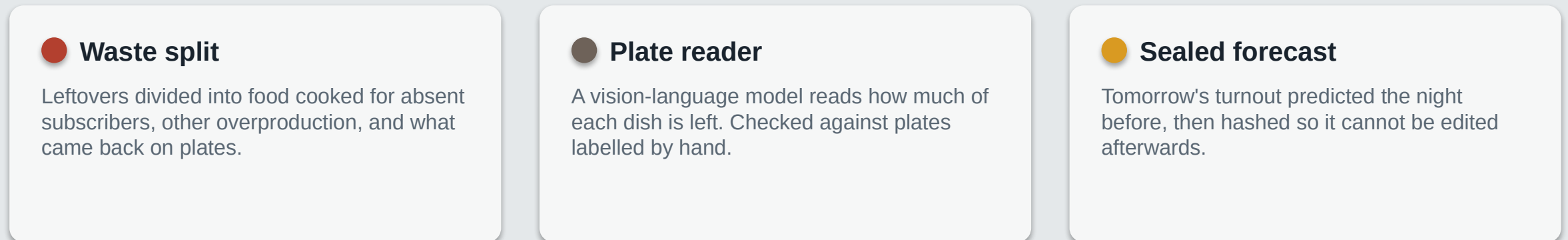
We followed the food from list to bin

Real photos · modelled figures

5 meals, Sat 26 Sep 07:30 to Sun 27 Sep 12:15. Collection ran at every service.



What we built

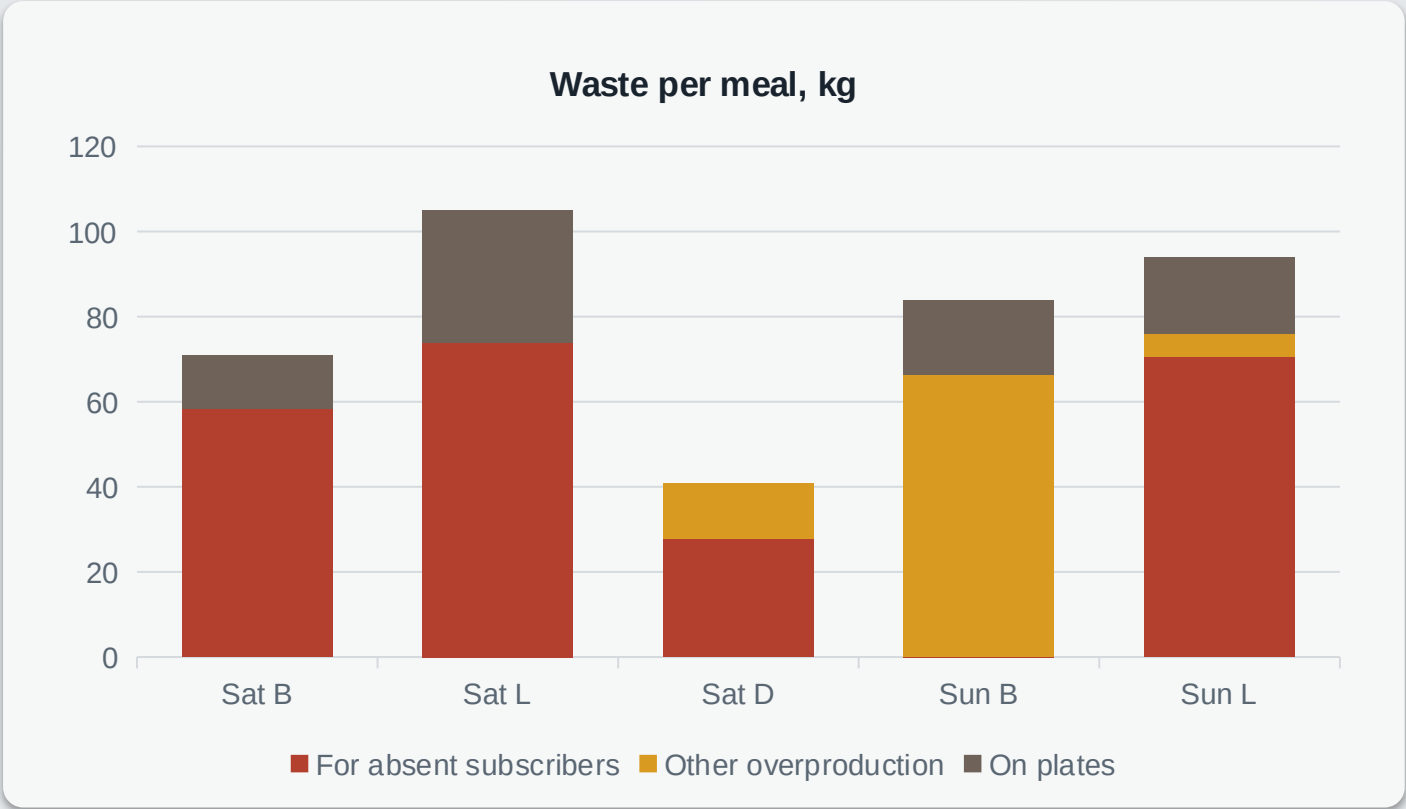


687 rows across 15 tables, each row carrying where it came from.

5 meals, 394 kg wasted, about ₹29,298

Real photos · modelled figures

58% was cooked for subscribers who never came. 20% came back on plates.



Sealed forecasts, 2 meals

17 diners off on average

Cooking for every subscriber: 98 off. 2 of 2 actual counts fell inside our range.

What changes for the manager

Cook to the sealed forecast, not the list. On these two meals it did not beat what the kitchen cooked: the lunch forecast came in low. Separately, egg comes back on plates more than anything else served.

What the data can't tell you: 5 meals in one mess, so this is a snapshot. Per-dish plate waste is inferred from photos. The ghost split assumes the kitchen cooks for subscribers; the implied headcount supports that.